

Derrick M. Barry

Tel: 0422 480 610

dezz.barry@proton.me

Communication designer working mostly across government, education and cultural organisations, on publication, identity and document systems that hold up across print and digital.

Selected Work

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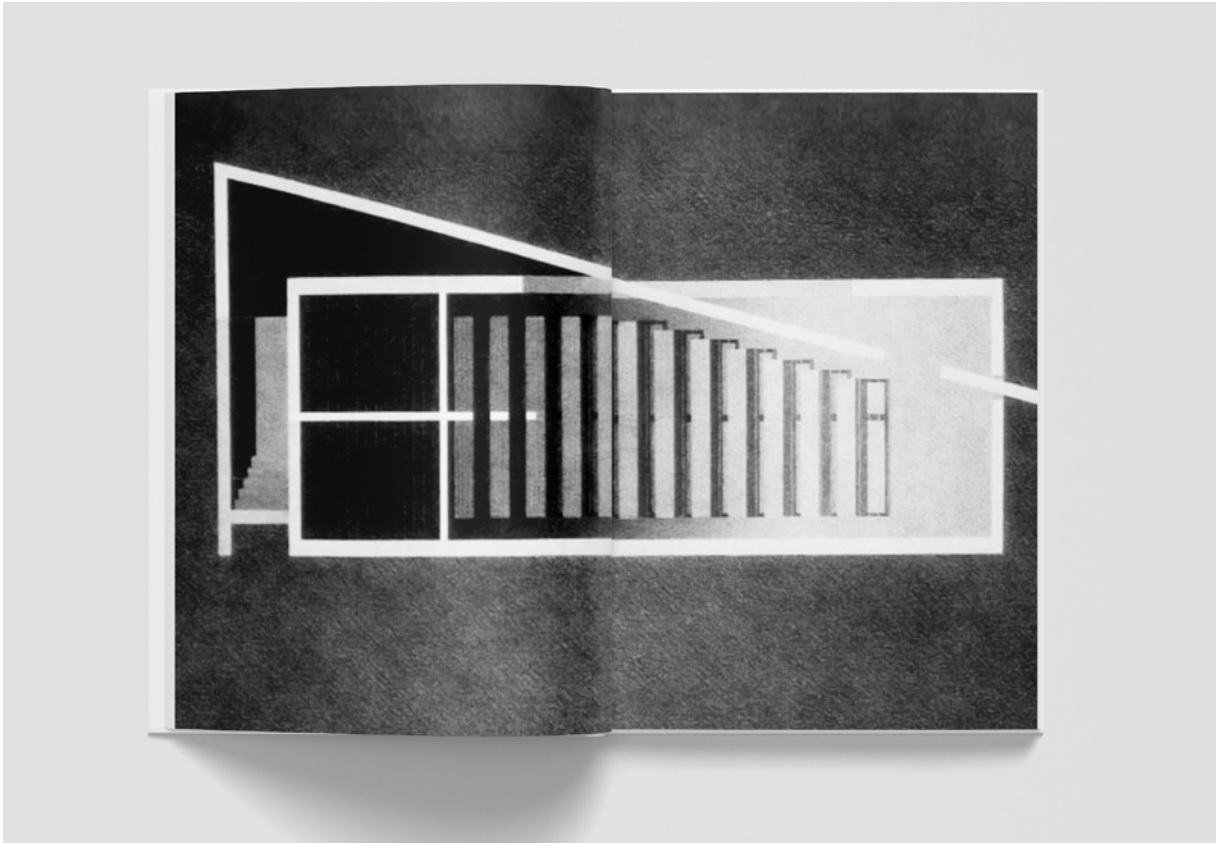
Role: Self-initiated research / design exploration

Ongoing self-directed design study exploring architecture as experience rather than object. Uses publication design as a way to examine ideas of light, shadow, sequence and transformation.

Developed as a research notebook to refine visual judgement, compositional thinking, and narrative pacing, informing later applied work in publication and systems design.

Notes

- Personal research project, not client work
- Images used for private study and internal reference only
- Focused on exploration rather than delivery



Selected spreads

Thresholds



Selected spreads

Form and Embrace



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

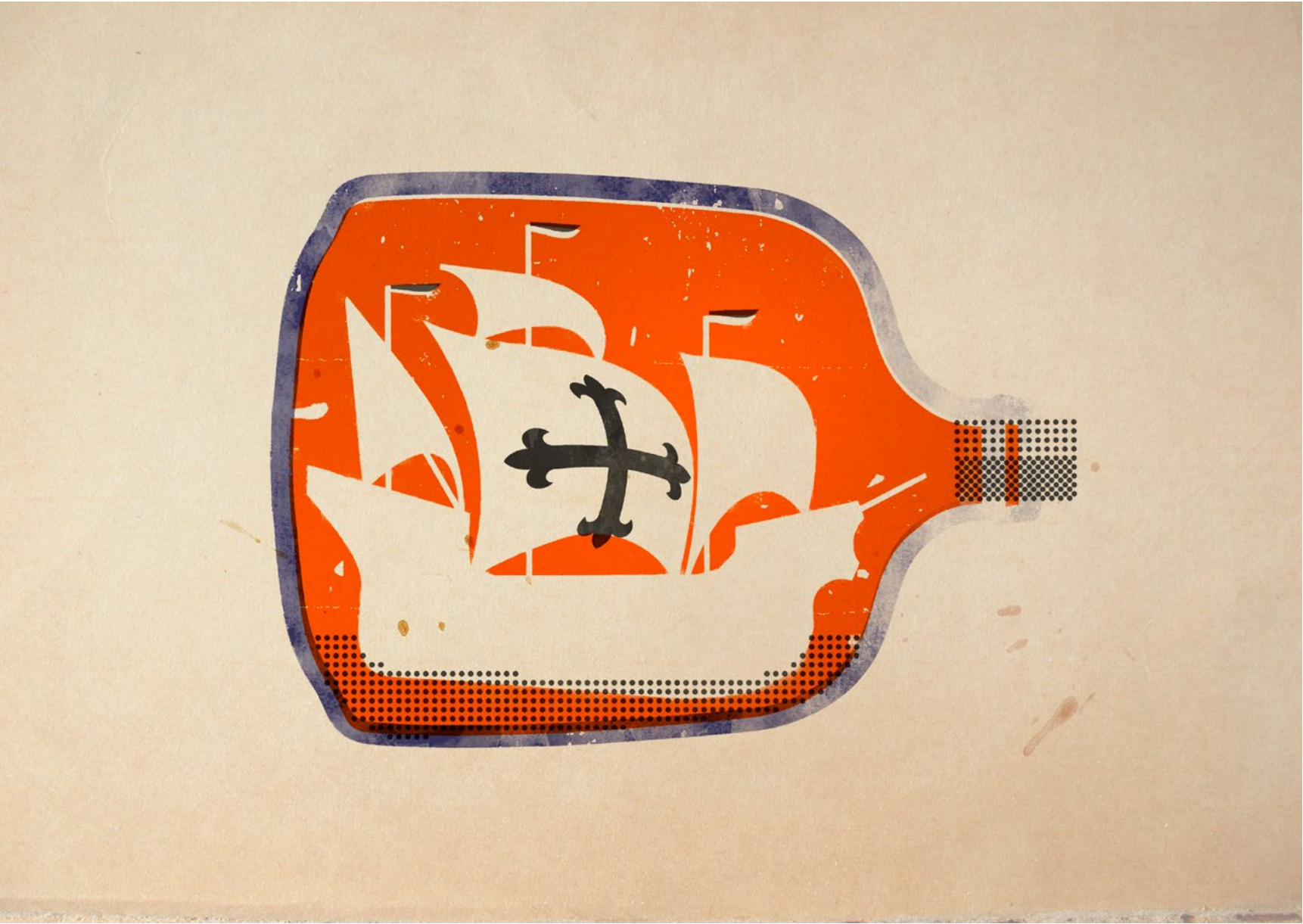
Led concept, design and execution of a compact visual identity system. Developed the “ship-in-a-bottle” mark to reflect meticulous, behind-the-scenes production and the delivery of complex work with clarity and reliability.

Key contributions

- Established a distinct, professional identity for a solo producer
- Used across digital touchpoints and client communications
- Reinforced positioning around care, accuracy and technical confidence

Outcome

The identity was designed to function consistently across digital, print and small-format applications, supporting a low-key but highly controlled production model.



Role: Concept Design / Art Direction

Developed a conceptual visual identity proposal for the Season of Excellence, an annual public-facing event celebrating outstanding student work from across Victoria.

The proposal explored a flexible brand system capable of representing diverse disciplines while maintaining a cohesive and credible public presence.



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

Worked on a government publication series aimed at making complex design principles accessible to a broad audience.

Led design, art direction and execution across multiple publications. Developed a flexible template and design system that enabled ongoing editions to be produced efficiently by different designers, while maintaining quality and coherence.

Key contributions

- Translated specialist design knowledge into clear, public-facing publications
- Built a reusable template system to support long-term use
- Reduced production friction and reliance on individual designers
- Supported handover and continuity within a government context

Outcome

A durable publication template still usable beyond the initial project, balancing accessibility, quality and institutional constraints.



+ Education



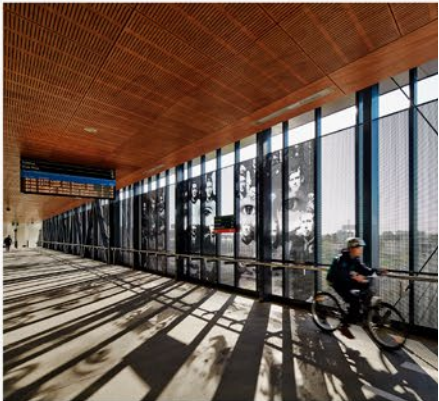
Good Design + Heritage



Good Design + Design Review



Good Design + Health



Good Design + Local Government



An intersection of three critical commitments is needed to achieve good design outcomes: project-specific design principles, selection of a skilled designer supported by a process of expert peer review.

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Good Design + Design Review

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VDRP Projects

Types and Sectors

The VDRP provides design review of projects at key stages of the design and development process. A project does not need to be going badly to benefit from design review. Rather the process adds input and expertise that builds on the skills of the design team and advice provided by stakeholders.

The VDRP is available for review of private and public projects that are of state significance due to their site, content, complexity, or because they establish a precedent for new development in a place. The project may be a civic or public facing building, have substantial government funding or be part of a departmental program, be innovative in its approach or addresses an emerging city issue.

The OVGA is committed to improved design outcomes for buildings and places used by all Victorians. This means that design review is offered for projects located throughout Victoria.

The VDRP reviews built environment projects of all types and scales including strategies, masterplans, buildings, major infrastructure, streets and public spaces.

PROJECT TYPES

Since its inception, the VDRP has reviewed a variety of projects from different sectors.

Residential27%

Civic and Cultural14%

Masterplan17%

Commercial11%

Tourism & Recreation13%

Infrastructure6%

Other12%

NUMBER OF PROJECTS

‘The VDRP is supported by members of the OVGA who bring a high level of professionalism in organising and conducting the review process with erudite precision and care. Our objectives were well understood from the initial briefing and the review proved to be a well tailored forum that addressed our key concerns.’

City Design

Maribyrnong City Council

STAGE AND INFLUENCE

Design review has a different focus and impact depending on project stage.

Value

Effectiveness of design decisions

Cost

Cost of changes to design

DESIGN REVIEW FOCUS

Brief

Project scope

Budget

Vision

Weighting of design

PROJECT INITIATION

Site analysis

Context/site response

Site layout

Benchmark projects

Design options

Design language

Form and massing

SCHEMATIC/CONCEPT DESIGN

Design integrity

Form and massing

Materials

Details

Value management

Delivery

DESIGN DEVELOPMENT

Design integrity

Materials

Details

Staging

Value management

Delivery

CONSTRUCTION DOCUMENTATION

CONSTRUCTION

Types and process of review

The VDRP can be used in a variety of ways to provide constructive input. The OVGA has adapted the process of design review to cater for the needs of different project types, scales and with various delivery methods. Regardless of the format of review, for it to be successful, it must be carried out using a robust and defensible process. Common features of design review processes include constructive independent advice informed by built environment experts, a deep understanding of projects, thorough briefing with regard for site, budget, planning controls and project scope in a structured discussion.

Design Review

Design review by the VDRP offers a process structured to provide effective advice. It involves thorough briefing, presentation by the client and designers, constructive review and summary written advice to the project team. Sessions are held regularly and a dedicated OVGA team works with the project team to guide them through the process. Projects are typically referred by state government or local government and selected based on significance and the ability of the advice to influence the design. Up to 5 panel members, with expertise tailored to the project, attend a VDRP design review session. The design team and client are in attendance to present the scheme and hear the panel's comments directly.

Desktop Review

Desktop reviews are a less structured, conversational form of review. The design team and panel discuss the proposal. It is particularly suited to projects which come to review at a very early stage, for follow-up reviews or at a very late point in the design process.

Pre Review Meeting

Depending on project stage another review will be scheduled

Panel Briefing incl Site Visit

Design review

Written Advice

Typical design review process including preparation, review and formal advice.

VDRP session

- Welcome
- Project team presentation
- Stakeholder comments
- Questions
- Review
- Summary

Design Quality Team (DQT)

For large complex ongoing projects or during a competitive selection process, the OVGA can establish a DQT. A multidisciplinary panel of up to four experts chaired by an OVGA representative, provides consistent and timely feedback at key points in the project process. A DQT may have a review role from project inception to delivery and can support stakeholders in ongoing decision making about design, including input to value management processes.

Urban Design Advisory Panel

The Urban Design Advisory Panel (UDAP) process was set up to review major transport infrastructure projects including Melbourne Metro, Level Crossing Removals and North East Link. The UDAP facilitates workshops and design advisory processes throughout the project, before major decisions or at project milestones. The UDAP is established to include members with professional expertise in architecture, urban design, strategic planning alongside key project stakeholders and local government representatives. The key focus for the UDAP is to provide collaborative, multidisciplinary, iterative, and consistent advice.

PORT OF SALE COMMUNITY HUB, 2017

CLIENT: Wellington Shire Council
ARCHITECT: FJMT
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: TCL

The OVGA supported Wellington Shire Council in pursuing a design led process to unlock the inherent qualities of the existing building and repurpose it as a new civic centre to celebrate Sale's status as a cultural centre. This was achieved on a modest budget demonstrating that a great idea does not need to be costly. Design review highlighted the need for a precinct masterplan in integrating the project with the broader cultural precinct. The Council was able to secure funding for landscape works to be delivered alongside the hub.

Photographer: John Gollings

Principles of design review

Design review processes offered by the OVGA have been refined and adapted from those documented by the UK Commission for Architecture and the Built Environment (CABE), a globally accepted benchmark. All processes are in line with the following principles of design review.

Independent

Design review is conducted by people who are unconnected with the scheme's promoters and decision makers, and it ensures the advice is unbiased.

Expert

It is carried out by suitably trained people who are experienced in design and know how to critique constructively. Review is most respected where it is carried out by professional peers of the project designers, because their standing and expertise will be acknowledged.

Multidisciplinary

Combines the different perspectives of architects, urban designers, planners, landscape architects, engineers and other specialist experts to provide a complete, rounded assessment.

Accountable

The Review Panel and its advice must be clearly seen to work for the benefit of the public. This is embedded within the panel's terms of reference.

Transparent

The panel's remit, membership, governance processes and funding is in the public domain.

Proportionate

It is used on projects that are significant to the State or communities.

Timely

It takes place as early as possible in the design process, because this can avoid a great deal of wasted time. It also costs less to make changes at an early stage.

Advisory

A design review panel does not make decisions, but it offers impartial advice for the people who do.

Objective

It appraises schemes according to reasoned, objective criteria rather than the stylistic.

Accessible

Its findings and advice are clearly expressed in terms that design teams, decision makers and clients can all understand and make use of.

Benefits and outcomes

Design review offers breadth of vision as well as support. The strength of a design review panel's advice lies in its independence, objectivity and ability to analyse a scheme within the context of wider good practice and knowledge. Expert peer review will highlight design strengths, challenge weaknesses and can lead to quicker negotiation of processes that lead to project delivery. Design teams, stakeholders and decision-makers benefit from design review.

Common positive outcomes from design review are:

- Support for and an increase in confidence of decision-makers in delivering high quality, inspiring developments and public spaces that meet the needs of all stakeholders
- Potential saving of time, money and effort by identifying issues at an early stage of the design process
- Support and encouragement of good designs and innovative proposals
- An increase in commitment to improved public amenity
- Effective site analysis informing contextually appropriate design
- Encourage high sustainability ambition
- Support in the recognition of good design outcomes when exercising discretion
- Design quality supported as important in the procurement process.

—80% of attendees reported significantly improved design outcomes by attending design review.

SQS Report, 2018.

Siting and Design Guidelines, 2020

CLIENT: Department of Environment, Land, Water and Planning
CONSULTANTS: REALM Studios

The Siting and Design Guidelines provide best practice advice on the siting and design of structures on the Victorian coast. The VDRP reviewed the document at draft stage providing confidence to stakeholders and recognising the need for buildings in coastal areas to respond to their place.

CAULFIELD TO DANDENONG LEVEL CROSSING REMOVAL, 2018

CLIENT: Level Crossing Removal Project (LXRP)
ARCHITECT: Cox Architecture
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: Aspect Studios

The Caulfield to Dandenong Level Crossing Removal project replaced nine dangerous rail level crossings with five elevated railway transport corridors. By elevating the line and stations, this project presented an opportunity to transform an extensive tract of land within Melbourne's metropolitan zone into a new linear park.

The OVGA provided expert design advice through the whole of project life-cycle, retaining consistent design expertise at all stages of the project including development, procurement and delivery through the LXRP Urban Design Advisory Panel (UDAP) using members of the VDRP.

Photographer: John Gollings

BENDIGO HOSPITAL, 2017

CLIENT: Victorian Department of Health
ARCHITECT: Bates Smart, Silver Thomas Hanley
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: Oculus

The Victorian Department of Health used the VDRP to form a Design Quality Team (DQT) to assist in the tender selection process for the \$600 million Bendigo Hospital contract.

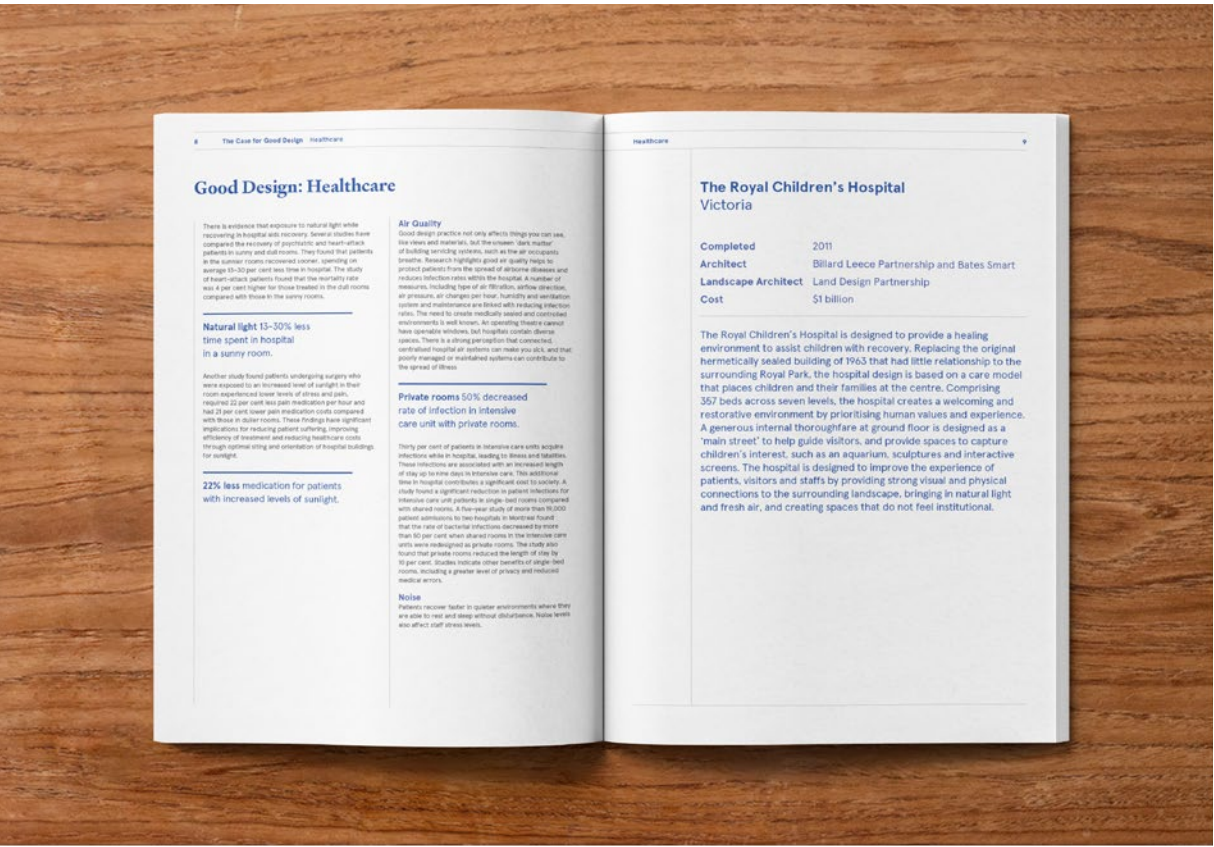
The involvement of the DQT in the tender evaluation process through to construction resulted in architecture, civic response and health planning recommendations that were subsequently implemented, resulting in a higher quality design outcome. The planning approvals process was also accelerated.

Photographer: Peter Clarke

dezz.barry@proton.me

Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

A Case for Good Design. An overview of research on how design shapes our surroundings and its impact across healthcare, education, workplaces, justice, housing, urban design and transport.



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

A full redesign of the VCE examination paper suite, addressing critical shortfalls in accessibility, branding and plain English standards. The project introduced a comprehensive visual system, automation tools and style guidelines — built to scale across more than 100 individual exam papers and adopted as the standard layout for language examinations across other Australian states.

One visual system. Every exam. Every student.

A full redesign followed, introducing automation tools and templates in InDesign to streamline team workflows and embed best practice at every stage.

Layout and editorial proofing standards were established, alongside a comprehensive suite of illustration, technical drawing and map style development.

Alternate format integration was built in from the ground up, ensuring accessibility across the full range of materials.



The Principles

The decisions were guided by three design principles:

- Clarity** – A clean, easy to navigate layout so students can focus on content, not format.
- Consistency** – A uniform design across all exams, reducing anxiety and building familiarity.
- Accessibility** – Accommodating diverse learning needs, ensuring every student can engage with the material without barriers.



The Approach

The redesign introduced a considered visual system of cleaner typography, better spacing and a consistent style across all exam papers and answer books, giving students a familiar, intuitive layout so they can focus on answering questions rather than navigating the page.

Key to this was a colour identifier system ensuring clarity and consistency across a series of exam papers, extending to the spine to make corresponding books and sheets immediately recognisable at a glance.

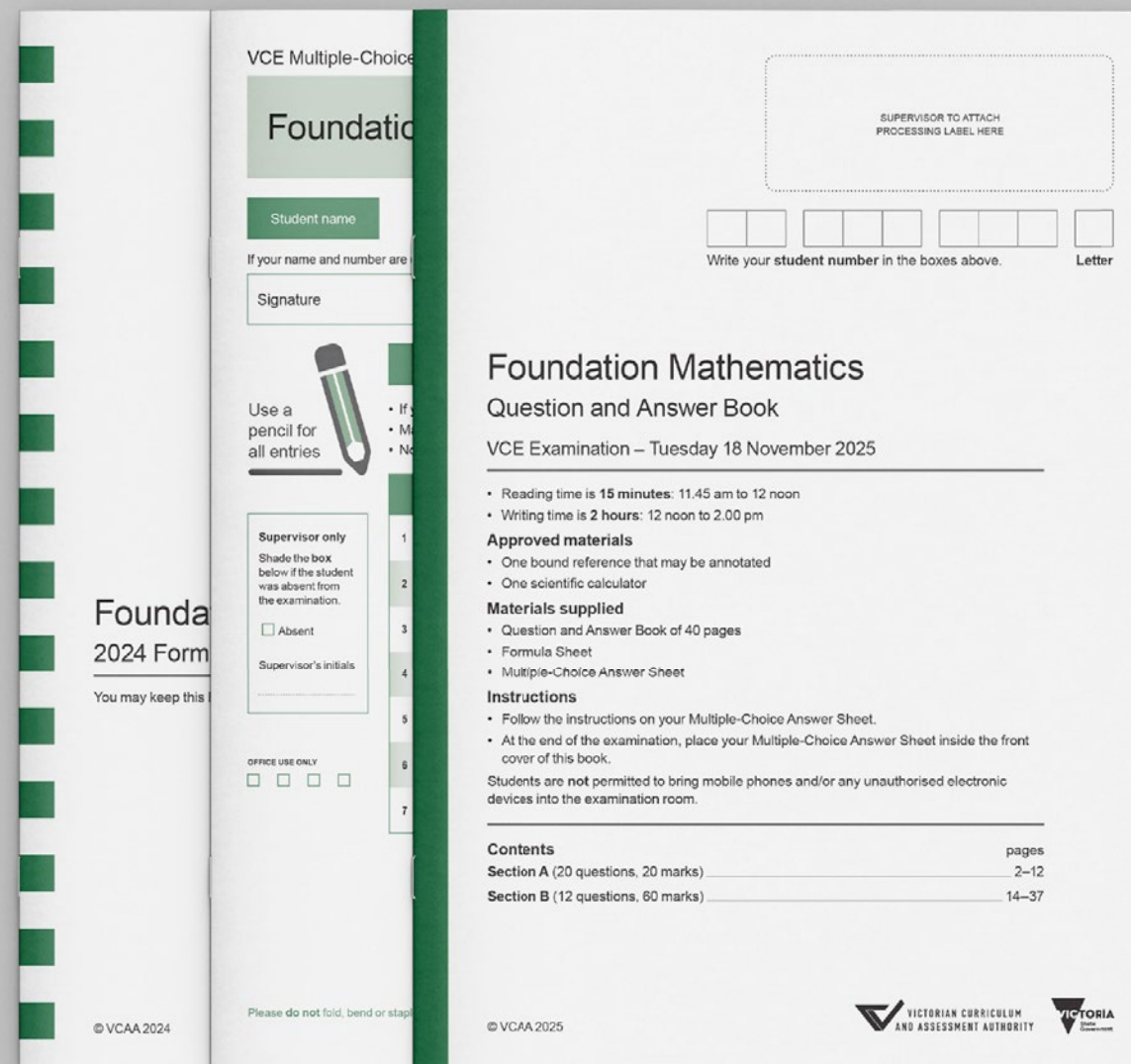


The Constraints

Examination papers must comply with precise scanning and marking requirements, OMR grids, critical clearspace, fixed technical boundaries and colour management. Working within those constraints, the redesign still achieved a considered, balanced layout across every page.



The Visual System



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

Departmental practice guide addressing linguistic diversity and multilingual development in early learning and education settings.

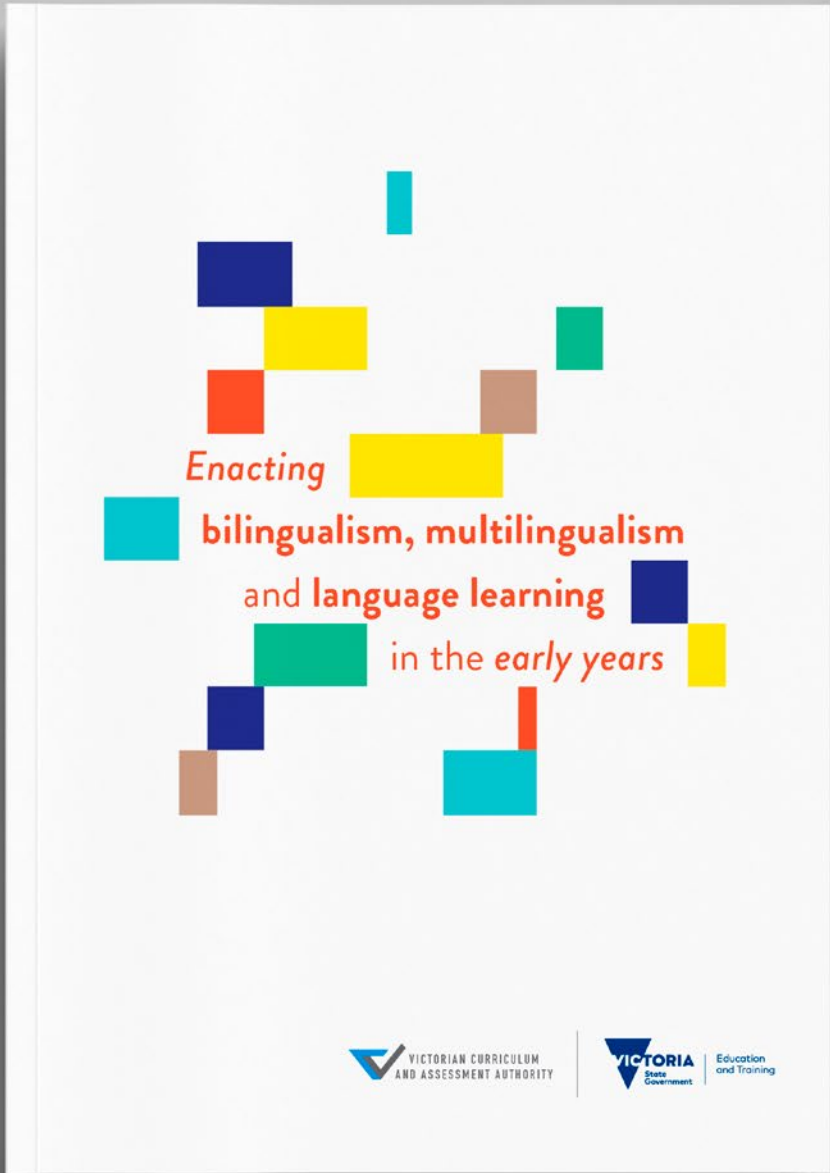
Led design and art direction to translate complex educational research into a clear, accessible resource for educators working with diverse student communities. Focused on clarity, inclusivity and real-world usability.

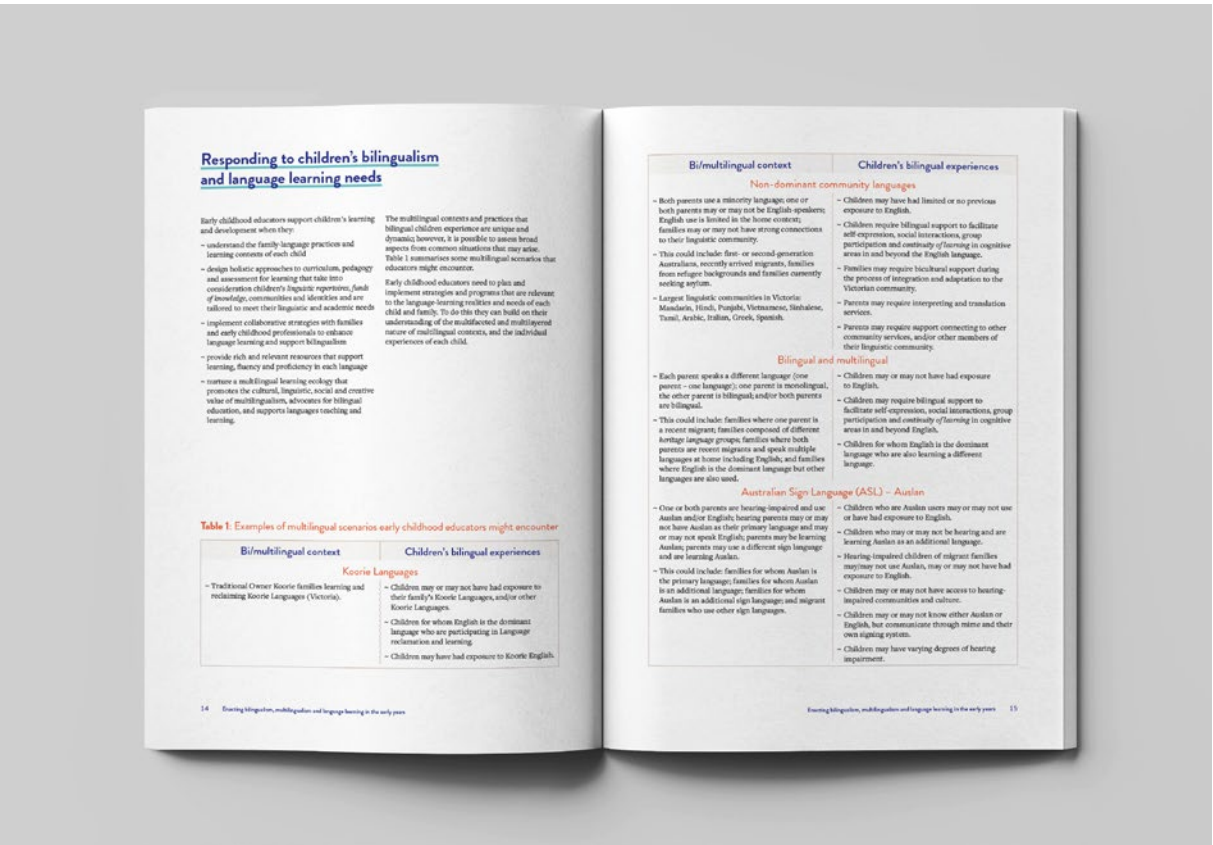
Key contributions

- Structured and visualised complex guidance for non-specialist audiences
- Balanced accessibility with departmental requirements and sensitivities
- Designed for practical use by educators

Outcome

A practical, educator-facing resource supporting inclusive practice across linguistically diverse settings.





Koorie Languages in Victoria

The vision of *Marrung: Aboriginal Education Plan 2016–2026* is that Victoria will be ‘a state where the rich and thriving culture, knowledge and experience of First Nations peoples are celebrated by all Victorians; where our universal service systems are inclusive, responsive and respectful of Koorie people at every stage of their learning and development journey; and where every Koorie person achieves their potential, succeeds in life, and feels strong in their cultural identity.’

Marrung commits to ‘increasing the number of Koorie Language programs in Victorian kindergartens and schools, by supporting community efforts at language learning through working with the Victorian Aboriginal Education Association Incorporated (VAEAI) and the Victorian Aboriginal Corporation for Languages (VACL), and providing assistance to support Koorie community members to undertake relevant language and teacher training courses.’

VACL has identified 38 different Traditional Owner Language groups in the state of Victoria.

According to VACL, ‘Language is important to Aboriginal people because it is a way for them to express their identity and be proud of where they come from and who they are. If a person knows a word in their language he/she is maintaining a link that has lasted thousands of years, keeping words alive that have been used by their ancestors – language is an ancestral right and it distinguishes something special about Aboriginal people from non-Aboriginal people. Language is a part of culture, and knowledge about culture is a means of empowering people. Language contributes to the wellbeing of Aboriginal communities, strengthens ties between Elders and young people and improves education in general for Indigenous people of all ages.’

The Victorian *Aboriginal Heritage Act 2006* recognises Aboriginal people as the primary guardians, keepers and knowledge-holders of Aboriginal cultural heritage. This includes intangible cultural heritage such as language. At a local level, Registered Aboriginal Parties (RAPs) are the voice of Aboriginal people in the management and protection of Aboriginal cultural heritage in Victoria.



The VEYLDF recognises and respects Aboriginal cultures and their unique place in the heritage and future of Victoria. Learning about and valuing the place of Aboriginal people will enhance all Victorian children’s sense of place in our community. (VEYLDF, p. 4)

Acehnese Acholi Afrikaans Akan Albanian
Assamese AssyrianNeo-Aramaic Auslan Azeri
Basque Bassa Belorussian Bemba Bengali
Burmese Cantonese Catalan Cebuano
Croatian Cypriot Czech Dan Danish Dari
Estonian Ewe Fijian Fijian Hindustani
Frisian Fulfulde Ga Gaelic Georgian
Gio-Dan Greek Gujarati Hakka
Hebrew Hiligaynon Hindi Hiri Motu
Iberian Romance Icelandic Igbo
Iranic Italian Japanese Javanese
Key Word Sign Australia Khmer
Konkani Korean Kpelle Krahn Krio
Letzeburgesch Liberian English Lingala Lithuanian
Lumun Luo Macedo-Romanian Macedonian
Mandaean (Mandaic) Mandarin Mandinka
Min Nan Mon Mongolian Mon-Khmer
Niue Norf'k-Pitkern Norwegian Nuba Moro Nuer
Pashto Persian Pidgin Polish Portuguese
Romany Rotuman Rundi Russian
Shilluk Shona Sindhi Sinhalese
Somali Spanish Spanish Creole Swahili
Tetum Thai Themne Tibetan Tigre Tigrinya
Tulu Turkic Turkish Turkmen Tuvaluan
Vietnamese Welsh Wu Xhosa

Amharic Anuak Arabic Armenian Aromunian
Balinese Balochi Baltic Bari
Bikol Bisaya Bislama Bosnian Bulgarian
Celtic Chaldean Neo-Aramaic Chin Haka Creole
Dhivehi Dinka Dravidian Dutch East Slavic
Filipino Finnish French French Creole
German Gilbertese Hazaraghi
Harari Hausa Hawaiian English
Hmong Hmong-Mien Hungarian Iban
Ilokano Ilonggo Indo-Aryan Indonesian
Kannada Karen Kashmiri
Kikuyu Kinyarwanda Kirundi Kiwai
Kuku Lumun Kurdish Lao Latin Latvian
Loma Lorma Luganda
Madi Malay Malayalam Maltese
Mann Maori Marathi Mauritian Creole
Moro Motu Nauruan Ndebele Nepali
Nyanja Oriya Oromo Pampangan
Portuguese Creole Punjabi Rohingya Romanian
Samoan Scottish Gaelic Serbian Seychelles Creole
Slovak Slovene Solomon Islands Pijin
Swedish Tagalog Tai Tamil Tatar Telugu
Timorese Tok Pisin Tokelauan Tongan Tswana
Ukrainian Urdu Uyghur Uzbek
Yapese Yiddish Yoruba Zomi Zulu

Role: Senior Designer / Digital Design (end-to-end)

Designed an interactive PDF toolkit guiding teams through different stages of project skills development.

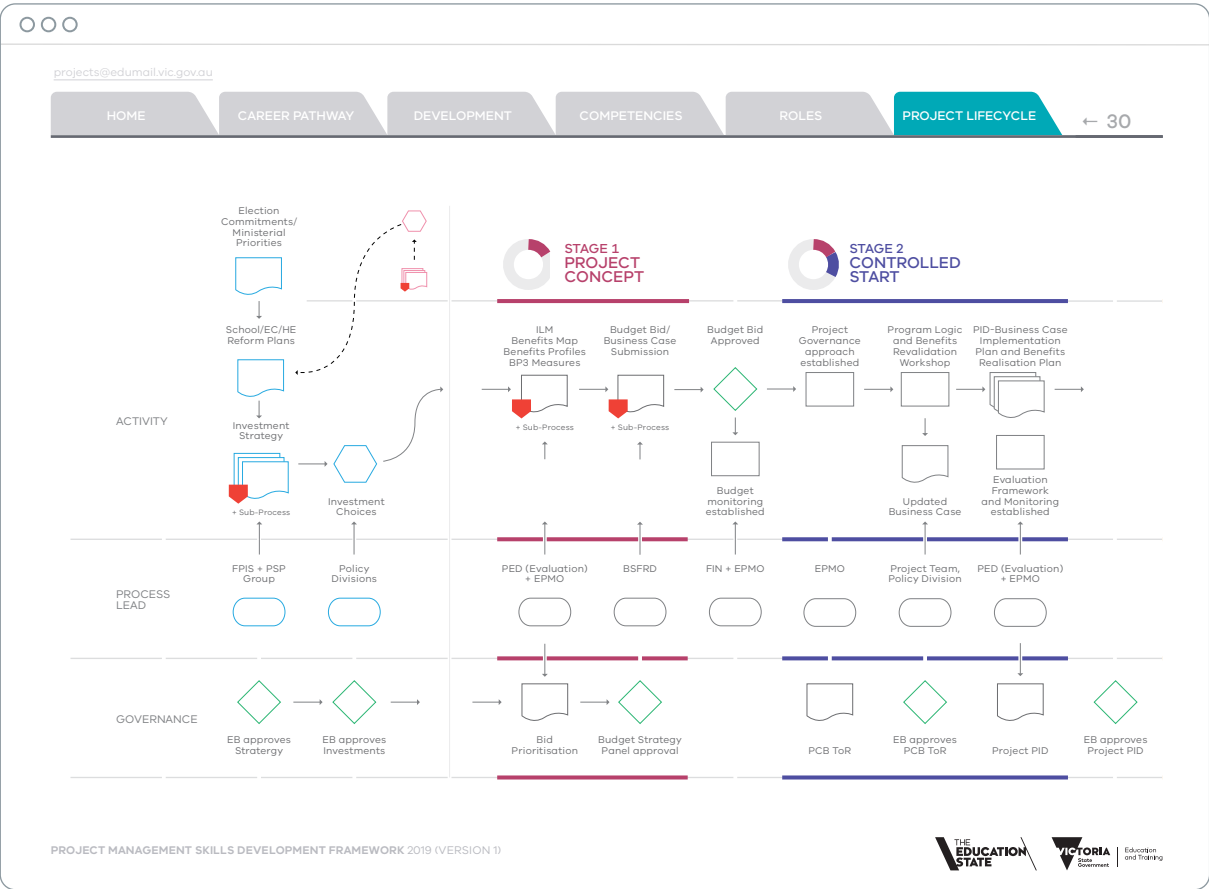
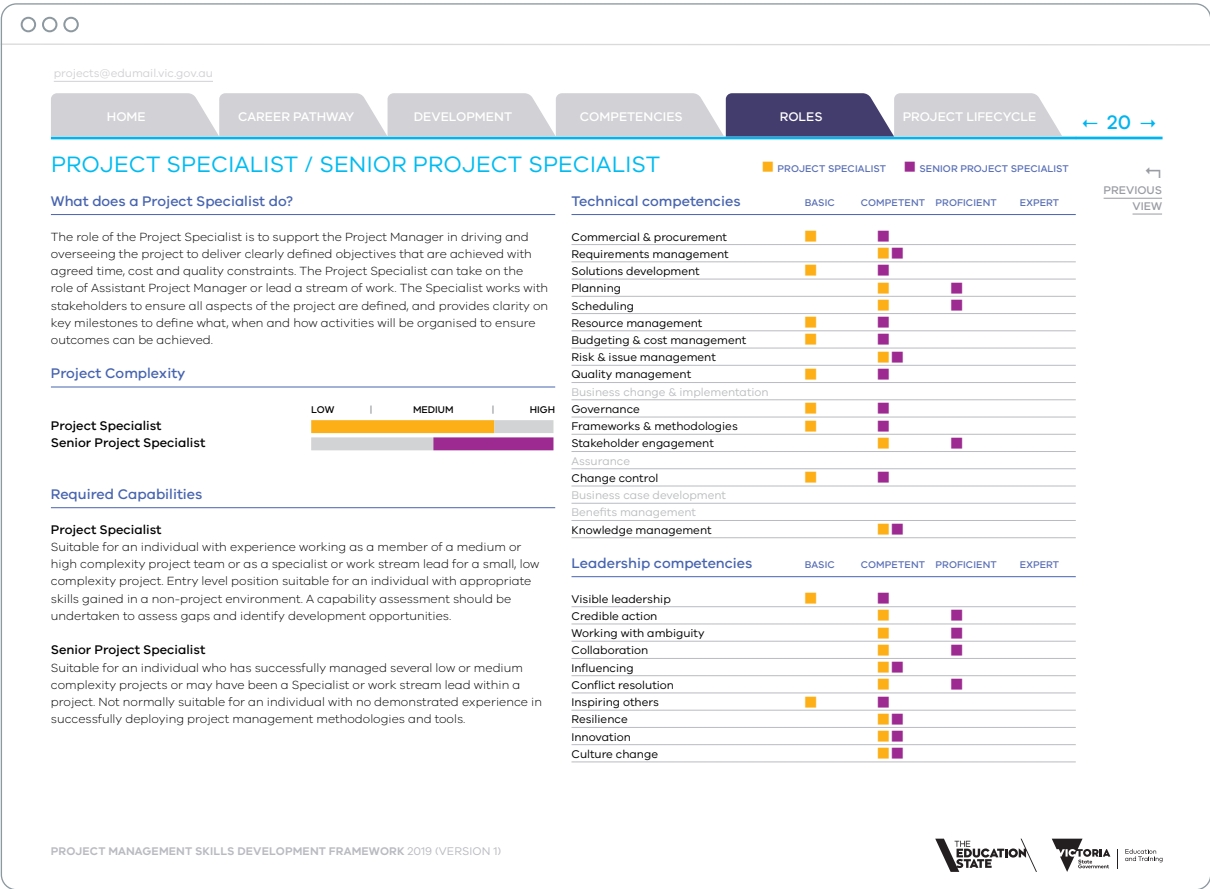
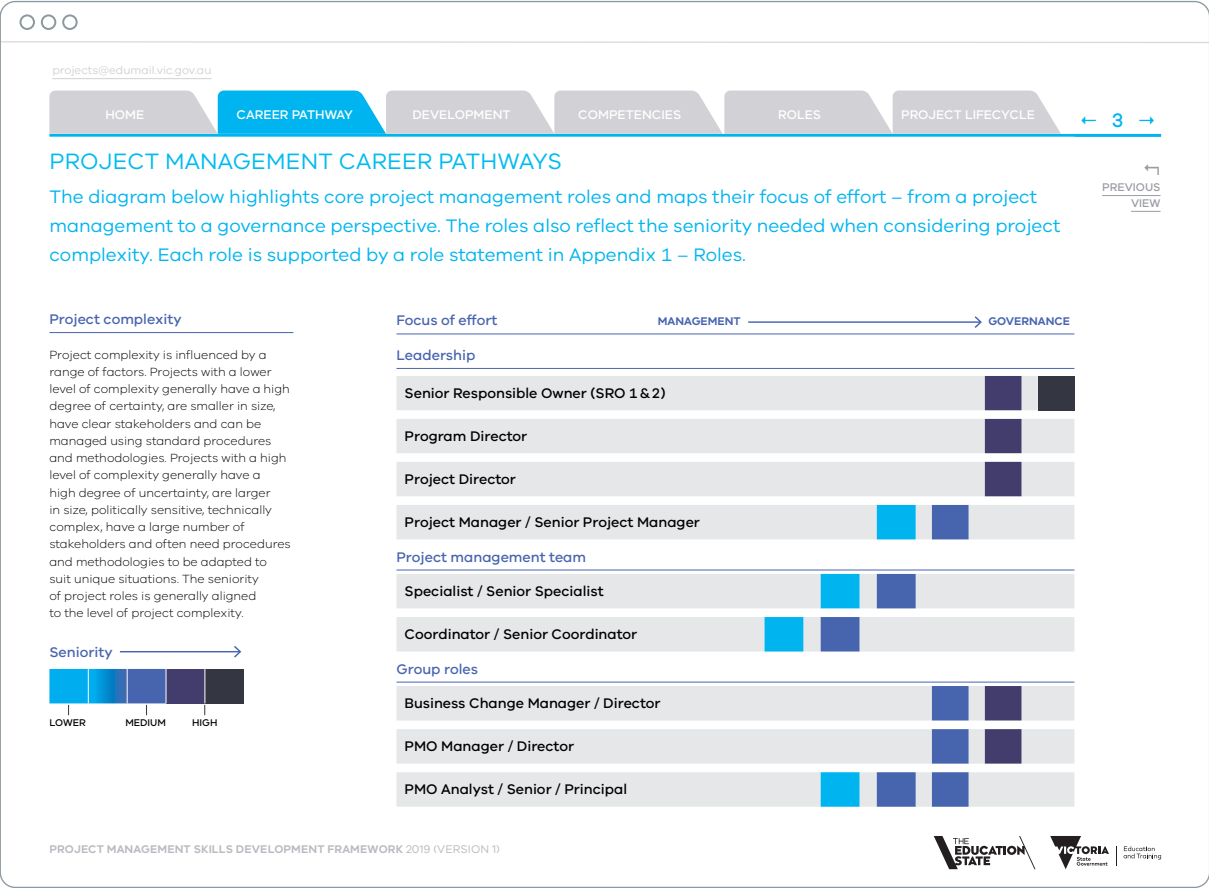
Built a user-driven navigation structure with extensive interactive features, allowing flexible access to relevant guidance rather than a fixed linear path.

Key contributions

- Designed interaction patterns for self-directed learning
- Improved usability of complex internal guidance
- Extended the handbook system into a practical digital format

Outcome

A low-friction, flexible resource supporting project capability uplift across the department.



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

Led design and art direction for a series of internal project management handbooks supporting consistent project delivery across the department.

Worked closely with subject matter experts to translate project management frameworks into clear, accessible resources for teams with varied experience levels.

Key contributions

- Structured complex operational guidance into usable handbooks
- Designed for clarity, accessibility, and adoption across diverse teams
- Supported consistent project delivery at scale



Bio

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Age: Unimportant

Hair: Blackish

Dominant Eye: Left

Skill: Recogniser

Derrick M. Barry

Tel: 0422 480 610

dezz.barry@proton.me